

SPEAKERS

Speakers have been around for a very long time and development has stabilised of late. We've tested all that we could get our hands on and in the process, we've seen many brands and various kinds of models of all shapes and sizes. Customers want more of everything - more of quality, more power, more features and more style. To keep things organised and to make choosing simple for our readers, speakers were split into two groups - 2.1 and 5.1 speakers. In many of the categories, we've had some products which turn to be better than the winners of the tests. In the speaker test, nothing like this happened. The Audioengine A2s were a good set of stereo desktop speakers without any separate subwoofer unit so they did not fall into the categories we tested.

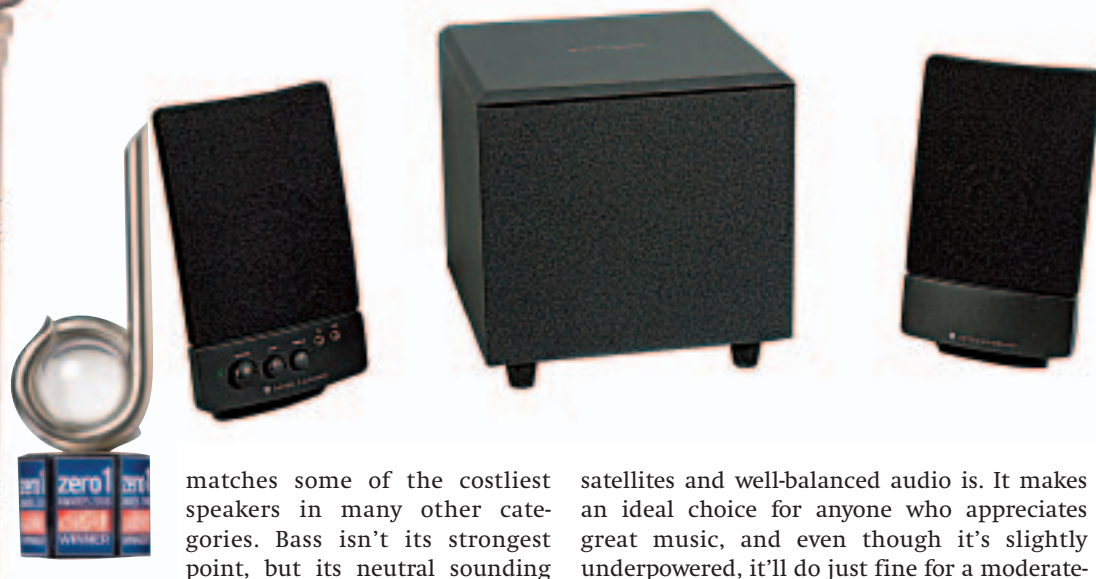
2.1 Speakers

The 2.1 speakers category has always been suited to true music enthusiasts. These are the speakers with two satellites and a woofer. Price hasn't been an issue so far as all of the speakers are priced sensibly.

BEST BUY

Altec Lansing BXR1121

The Altec Lansing BXR1121 is available for just Rs 1,199. At this price, what you get is great quality despite not being the most powerful speaker of the lot. The quality



matches some of the costliest speakers in many other categories. Bass isn't its strongest point, but its neutral sounding



BEST PERFORMER (2.1)

Altec Lansing MX5021

The Altec Lansing MX5021 was one of the speakers that impressed within moments of listening to. These speakers were a lot better than the others we tested. The woofer is most sturdy and produces the tightest bass and when you need it to, it can pump out some smoothened boomy bass as well. The satellites are excel-

lent on the high end frequencies. The speakers had a very crisp and accurate character to them - something that wasn't so clear in every other speaker set. This 90 W speaker set is among the most powerful ones of the lot. The MX5021 comes with great cables and a stylish and a very usable remote control. There's even a wireless remote control!



BEST PERFORMER (5.1)

Logitech Z-5500

The Logitech Z-5500 is some of the largest and the most powerful speakers of the ones we tested through the year. At 500 W, these were by-far the most powerful. They come as a set of five huge satellite speakers and one gigantic subwoofer. Everything about these speakers is about size. Cables are long. There's a huge console for changing the settings for the speakers. A huge heatsink at the rear of the subwoofer keeps it cool. All kinds of sound effects and standards are supported to give you the most accurate replication of sound as possible. If tightness of the bass is to be compared, then it's not as hard as the Altec Lansing MX5021 from the group of 2.1 speakers. That's about the only real complaint that we have.

We love the Z-5000's but at Rs 27,995 back in April, they're still overly expensive for everyone to buy but they are the best for surround sound.

ly sized room. The Altec Lansing BXR1121 demonstrates that quality doesn't have to be unaffordable.

BEST BUY

Altec Lansing VS3251

The Altec Lansing VS3251 is a great option for those who don't want to spend on the Logitech Z-5500. The VS3251 can be bought for just Rs 4,490. The VS3251 although meant for movies is very good for music playback as well. The sound is warm. The bass isn't really strong so it's not very ideal for movie buffs. The speakers went through all our tests perfectly fine. There was hardly any distortion when the volume was turned up high. The speakers are well built, and a large chunky remote comes with them.

5.1 Speakers

5.1 speakers on the other hand are best for movies and games. Surround sound is most important and has almost no meaning for the stereo music that we all listen to. All the tests we did were similar to 2.1 speakers but movie quality and experience were given more priority.

